



CAMBRIDGE CYCLE CLUB NEWSLETTER



cambridgecc.org.uk

THE HUB

AUTUMN 2014

Steven Edwards



Allez, allez: fans cheered on the Cambridge riders as they chased down the pros

Chasing the Tour

"On July 7th 2014, I rode stage three of the Tour de France." How many club cyclists can can say that? It's a story that six Cambridge CC riders will be able to regale at café stops until the next time Grande Boucle comes to town.

For most cycling fans, having the world's greatest cycling race come to your city can provide an experience they will never forget. Watching Chris Froome, Alberto Contador and Vincenzo Nibali riding on our local roads, albeit a bit faster, can really bring the Tour de France to life. But for six CCC members, that was never going to be enough so they embarked on a dream to ride the Tour.

Wes Ullrich, Dan Levy, Chris Brown, Charles Pearson, Oliver Caddy and Bjorn Krylander watched as the peloton flew down Trumpington road, before jumping on the back of the final car in the race convoy to pursue the world's greatest cyclists.

Riding through-and-off down the A1301 is not to be recommended, but with the roads closed to traffic and cheers of encouragement from the crowds on the roadside, the half-dozen riders made it all the way to Saffron Walden.

With the local press calling for readers' photographs from the roadside, pictures of the local grupetto appeared in Cambridgeshire and Essex newspapers captioned as Tour de France riders, leaving Cambridge CC as the unofficial 23rd team of the 2014 Tour De France.

ON THE NEWS

Two of our best-looking members Gabriel Bienzobas and Gavin Bennett were interviewed live on ITV news East Anglia for their opinion on the Tour de France coming to our region.

Watch the video at <http://bit.ly/1o7zTqi>



WATCH THE VIDEO

Footage from the roadside of the CCC riders can be seen at <http://on.fb.me/11dVK40>



The club's annual awards dinner will be held on Saturday, 29th of November 2014, at 7pm at the University Centre on Granta Place.

Food and drink will be provided as well as the opportunity to socialise with your fellow club members (hopefully) dressed in something other than lycra for once.

This year our guest speaker is Cambridge-based former paralympic cyclist Dr Dan Gordon.

Dr Gordon, competed for GB in three sports across an athletic career over 20 years. He won medals at European Championships in track and field and National medals in swimming. His greatest successes though came through cycling. As a tandem stoker riding with Barney Storey, the pair, pictured above right, racked up a series of international victories. Since retiring from competitive sport in 2008, Dan has worked as a consultant physiologist to

Awards night



athletes and teams from a wide array of backgrounds including, GB Paralympic Endurance squad, Trans-Atlantic rowers, Badwater ultra-marathon runners and GB rowers.

Tickets cost £25 per person. Please reserve a place by e-mailing social.secretary2014@gmail.com and indicate whether you have any dietary requirements. Payments can be made by bank transfer (account number 04459768, sort code 09-01-50). Cheques are also accepted. Please make them payable to Cambridge Town and County Cycling Club.

Bookings close on Friday, November 14th 2014.

CCC ladies battle Bertha at Ride London

AUGUST 10TH

Frequent checking of the weather forecast the night before did nothing to improve the forecast.

We got up in the morning feeling nervous but happily it was dry as we headed to the start at the Queen Elizabeth Olympic Park. However, having to wait over an hour until our allocated start time did nothing to calm the nerves. Sure enough, the rain started just before we were told the news that due to the very heavy rain and high winds the organisers had decided to cut 14 miles off the route. This meant we were to be diverted around the main challenge; that of climbing Leith and Box hill. Disappointing news but when the rain started in earnest we understood why. Witnessing several people hit the ground in the difficult conditions including the poor soul in the ambulance that meant we had to walk for 20 minutes through Richmond park rather than cycle.

Noelle, Ramona and Cara and I were able to ride as a team and having some company really helped keep us motivated. But the real driving force was knowing we'd been supported by so many generous friends and family who donated to Arthur Rank hospice.



Rain, rain, please go away!



Grin and bear it: not even the biblical conditions would prevent the team from getting round

The rain was, in Chris Boardman's words, biblical. The roads turned to rivers and we dodged the floods as much as possible. But staying dry was never going to happen.

Our lowest moment was actually on top of Newlands corner where we stopped to eat and fill bottles. On a clear day we would be admiring the views of the Surrey hills but the horizontal rain made that impossible. We were all shivering, but when Cara's lips turned blue we decided it was definitely time to get cycling again. By then she was shaking so violently on the descent that her front wheel was shaking too but we took it slow to ensure our safety.

Finally, with 25 miles to go, the sun came out and a tail wind appeared - heaven to weather-battered cyclists. We all enjoyed a mini-team time trial over the last 20 miles as the road dried out. As the crowds appeared

from under their umbrellas, we were greeted by lots of "go Cambridge girls!" as we flew past.

The finish line on the Mall was definitely our highlight, with the support from people watching fantastic and it's such an iconic finish to a bike race. It was amazing to be able to ride the whole event on closed roads. The team time was recorded as 6:08, which was in

the top ten of female teams - which means we achieved our challenge set by a sponsor of finishing in the top half female finishers!

We posed for one photo with our medals before another deluge soaked us again. Time to head home, dry out and remember a fantastic day - despite Bertha's best efforts!

KATE SANDERS



All smiles and sunglasses on the Mall at the end of ride



Louis, right, with his bronze medal at the National Track Championships

Rocket Rolfe repeats Nationals success

SEPTEMBER 24TH

Paracyclist Louis Rolfe has beaten his own record and picked up a bronze medal in the National Track Championships wearing Cambridge CC colours.

The 17 year-old Cambridge Regional College student, a member of the GB Paralympic development squad, set a new British record of 4 minutes 13.464 seconds with a fantastic performance - smashing the record 4 minutes 20.561 seconds he set last year.

Louis has represented Great Britain three times this year, and travelled with the team to Italy and Switzerland for championships earlier this summer - his first experience of international competition.



Parnell takes the honours at Circuit of the Fens

JULY 27TH

A pan flat circuit around the fens out of Whittlesey in a rolling road closure, mainly on smooth road surfaces but with a couple of droves chucked in to keep you on your toes. This year's route was altered slightly to add a gravel track to the race.

Toby Parnell, Edward Farnell and Oliver Caddy made up the Cambridge CC contingent, with David Mclean riding in Cambridge University RT colours.

Starting fast, the riders set out over the narrow bridge onto the main circuit. The riders were allowed full use of the road due to a rolling road closure, which helped to combat the crosswinds.

Just as echelons began to form and riders looked to form a break, the race was halted for an hour due to an accident in the middle of the premier calendar event. The crash involved a rider who had fallen out the back of the rolling road closure and was trying to ride back on. With his head down, he didn't see a steam roller stationary in the road ahead of him. Thankfully the air ambulance was prompt and he was sped off to Addenbrooke's.

The harrowing wreck of his bike left by the side of the road as we passed it as the race re-started acted as

a sobering reminder to keep your head up, no matter how hard you're riding.

With only 15 miles remaining, 5 of which were neutralised, the race was twitchy. With the first of two farm track sections approaching, riders were keen to remain in good positions at the front of the bunch. Some riders worked hard to push through, powering their bikes over the rough surface while others slowed to avoid the bigger holes.

With the bunch shaken up, there was little time to relax as after rolling round a couple of corners the motorcycle outriders turned down another gravel track, this time worse than the first section. With large stones in riders' paths from gutter to gutter, riders had no choice but to power through. Race organisers had warned participants of the section in the weeks preceeding the race and had advised appropriate wheel and tyre selection.

The punctures soon came thick and fast as riders cursed their luck on the terrain. Reports of up to twenty riders stood by the side of the road waiting for spare wheels and the broom wagon were more than understandable.

After getting back onto tarmac, riders attempted to break clear. Anthony Morris of CC Ashwell attacked with five miles to go. Morris, currently second overall in the individual ERRL rider standings, put in a strong run to the finish, but the flat, windy circuit played into the hands of the rampaging bunch. East London Velo's Wayne Crombie caught the escapee yards from the finish, only for Toby Parnell to cross the line first and take the win for Cambridge CC. A fantastic performance in one of the season's biggest races and Toby followed Adam Blythe, Chris Opie and Russell Downing onto the podium after the elite race results.



Tyler has continued to race for CCC in the US

Trans-Atlantic success

SEPTEMBER 1ST

Tyler Denmead, who despite moving to the US a while back, is still racing for Cambridge CC and won the 2014 Benton Park Criterium.

The 1.7 mile circuit was a technical one with 10 corners and the race was shortened to 35 minutes. After a prime lap, Tyler attacked with 15 minutes still to go, only to be caught a lap later. With a break of two going a few laps after, Denmead remained in the chase group until the last lap.

With a mile to go, Tyler found himself on the front with the unenviable task of leading the chase. With other riders coming through to help, he went solo off the front with three quarters of a mile left. The first escapee was soon caught and he picked off the last guy at the final corner before crossing the line first.

The highlight was yet to come with Tyler receiving kisses from the Michelob girls before being joined on the podium with his two children..

Going for glory: Patrick puts the power down on the final climb



Sudbury RR comes down to final sprint

AUGUST 30TH

The first road race organised by CC Sudbury for 20 years saw Patrick Graf take his second victory of the season.

The 50-mile race took in four laps of a circuit that passed through the picturesque villages of Belchamp Otten, Belchamp St Paul, Knowl Green, Little Yeldham, Gestingthorpe and Bulmer.

Three Cambridge riders joined Graf on the start line, including Nigel Hobday and Tom Begg. A furious opening saw the first rider dropped in the first mile, and a few more lost touch with the peloton before the end of the first 13-mile lap, which averaged just short of 25mph.

Ian Cullen (Army Cycling Union) made the first proper

break of the race and managed to get a gap of over 40 seconds in a solo attempt at the end of the first lap.

He was pulled back by the bunch after his effort and at the end of the second lap another break of half a dozen riders, including Steve Hubbard (CC Sudbury) and James Wylie (Velo Schils — Interbike) had formed and they held a gap of 30 seconds before being brought back into the bunch before the end of the lap.

There was a small crash in the second lap which saw a number of forced retirements and then the third lap slowed

to an average of just under 23mph with no clear break as the riders prepared themselves for the all-important final lap.

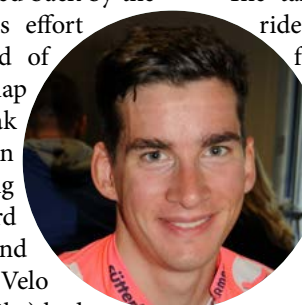
The tail wind helped the riders hold over 30mph from Gestingthorpe towards the final stage of the race and the finish was destined to be decided by a bunch sprint.

But in the last turn to the finish there was some traffic that, despite the best efforts of the British Cycling-accredited marshals, stopped in the road and reduced the space the riders had available to use which caused a number of them to hit the brakes.

There were a few riders that came down as the road narrowed, but the first aiders were not kept too busy patching the small number of bumps and scrapes.

With the final sprint approaching, Patrick, inset, powered up the last ascent of Finch hill to secure first with a time of two hours, nine minutes and four seconds. Ben Howell of Strada Sport crossed the line just six seconds later, just taking second place from Matthew Heath (East London Velo).

All the racers and helpers were rewarded with refreshments at the event HQ at AFC Sudbury with the top 10 finishers receiving cash prizes.





Adam, Tom, Laura and Karla get into the spirit

Mountain bikers pull an all-nighter

OCTOBER 4TH

An intrepid bunch of MTBers ventured into Thetford forest for the night to take part in the infamous Dusk til Dawn 12 hour enduro race. Cambridge had a large contingent taking part for various relay teams.

There were two 'mixed three' teams: Wes Ullrich, Ed Farnell and Laura Massey made up the first with David McLean, Shane Norval and Karla Boddy in the second and one all-male team consisting of Chris Brown, Gordon Hollingworth and Steve Fuller.

Cambridge CC also had a second claim representative in the form of Andrew Cockburn riding for AW cycles in a pair with Tom Ward and another team of four Cambridge CC riders representing Primo Cycles: Tom Vickery, Charles Pearson, Adam Tapley and Luke Hattersley. The CTTers and BC people reading this will be shocked to know that the MTB world is much more relaxed when it comes to who you ride for: second claim, first claim, different clubs and riders coming together for different events makes for a fun and varied

season for everyone. Indeed we were privileged to have Laura and Karla to represent their second-claim club over Team Scott-Contessa Epic to help us form mixed squads.

The race only started at 8pm and continued until 8am, the laps were usually taking us between 40 and 45 minutes and the teams of three were doing one or two laps each before changing riders. The hottest competition within the club was between the two mixed three teams, who were within a few minutes of each other the whole night.

At one point early on, Karla lost time due to a slippery seatpost and a light making a bid for freedom into the forest, later we caught back up when Ed Farnell wandered off for a loo break and missed his changeover. Meanwhile Chris had to do three laps instead of two because Gordon went

walkabout. These things happen when you replace sleeping with cycling.

Things came to a climactic finish for the mixed threes as Shane did a sterling turn to close the gap to about 30 seconds at around 4:30am. I took over and bridged across to Wes Ullrich to draw level. When I caught him he was sitting on the wheel of a half-man, half machine, forever anonymous, night-riding superstar in a Rabobank jersey, who in a sleepy daze I dubbed "Eric Dekker". The two of us clung to his wheel for grim death as he got faster and faster, hoping not to get dropped. At the end of the lap he peeled off and I attacked my own clubmate, in true CCC fashion, on the untechnical section through the finish, making a gap on Wes. It was a little after 5am and, in hindsight, was a somewhat cruel tactic but I am a roadie at heart and I have no shame when doing such things.

It all came to no avail

though, I came in exhausted to hand over to Karla, who did a lap before handing on to Shane for the final lap of the night. By now it was Shane vs Ed to the line. Ed started with a few minutes lead whilst Shane, who's knee had started to play up, was closing fast, but not fast enough. In the end there was only a couple of minutes in it after 12 hours.

Our two teams were the fastest two mixed three teams but to our dismay we were lumped in with the mixed 4s, two of which beat us. Wes, Ed and Laura took the last spot on the podium whilst Shane, Karla and I took 4th in commiseration. Steve, Gordon and Chris were 8th in the very competitive male 3s, Andy C and Tom came 2nd in the male pairs (and did 3 more laps than the rest of us!) whilst Primo came 8th in the male four category.

All in all it was an excellent night, despite it dipping to just 1 degree celsius at the coldest part of the night. The atmosphere at our little camp under the gazebos was great, if a little chilly and smoky. We shall be back next year, hopefully with even more teams.

To get involved in the CCC MTB scene then go to www.facebook.com/groups/CCCMTB

DAVID MCLEAN



Ed and Wes stayed awake just long enough to collect their trophies

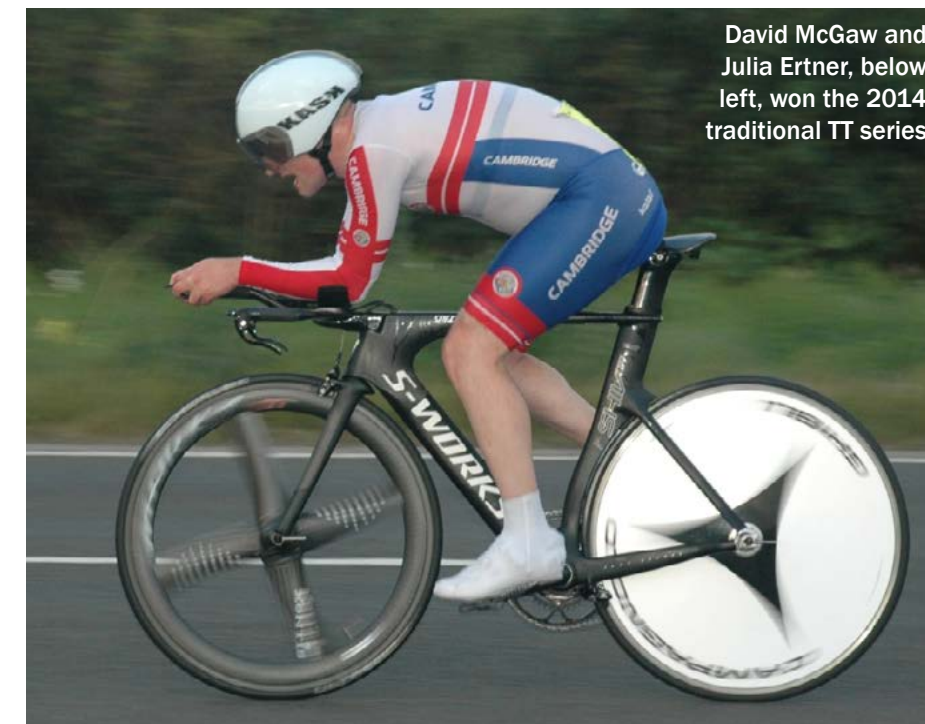
2014 time trial report

The addition of an Eddy Merckx-style road bike league gave a welcome boost to the numbers of participants in the Cambridge CC evening time trials. The 2014 season saw on average 32 riders compete every week, 12 of whom were on standard road bikes.

We had been wondering over the last few years why the general increase in the popularity of cycling had not been reflected in our time trials. The answer to the question was a lot simpler than we had anticipated. Proving Lance Armstrong's theory of 'It's not about the bike' the appeal of turning up on your normal road bike widened the appeal of time trials. We're already looking forward to next season and hoping even more people will be inspired to have a go at time-trialling.

Thank you to all involved in helping and organising the evening time trials, without the help of volunteers we cannot run these kind of events.

JAN ERTNER



David McGaw and Julia Ertner, below left, won the 2014 traditional TT series

THE WINNERS OF THE FOUR MAIN COMPETITIONS

MORRIS SHIELD

1st David McGaw 200 points (wins Morris Shield & gold medal)

2nd Chris Brown 183 points (silver medal)

3rd Martin Reynolds 174 points (bronze medal)

COLE CUP

1st Julia Ertner 98 points (wins Cole cup & gold medal),

2nd Pam Missenden 93 points (silver medal)

3rd Noelle Godfrey 77 points (bronze medal)

EDDY MERCKX SERIES (MEN)

1st Steve Fuller 100 points (Cup & gold medal),

2nd Oliver Caddy 99 points (silver medal)

3rd Wes Ullrich 97 points (bronze medal)

EDDY MERCKX SERIES (WOMEN)

1st Tania Wicklow 69 points (Cup & gold medal),

2nd Noelle Godfrey 65 points (silver medal)

3rd Vanessa Holzer 50 points (bronze medal)

CCC CLUB 10MILE CHAMPIONSHIP Men

1st David McGaw 21.21 (September Plate & gold medal)

2nd Chris Brown 23.07 (silver medal)

3rd Nick Jackson 23.28 (bronze medal)

Women

1st Julia Ertner 27.55 (gold medal)

2nd Vanessa Holzer 29.14 (silver medal)

3rd Tania Wicklow 29.33 (bronze medal)

CCC CLUB 25MILE CHAMPIONSHIP Men

1st Nick Jackson 58.41 (John Brown Cup & gold medal)

2nd Martin Callaway 59.29 (silver medal)

3rd Martin Reynolds 59.39 (bronze medal)

Women

1st Julia Ertner 1.11.12 (gold medal)

2nd Pam Missenden 1.13.32 (silver medal)

3rd Vanessa Holzer 1.15.48 (bronze medal)



Notification of club AGM

The Club's Annual General Meeting is to be held on Monday, October 27th, 2014. The aim is to re-elect the committee for 2015 and to discuss any issues with other club members.

There are vacancies for the committee, including records secretary, club run captain and club coach. That said, all roles will be available and it would be great to have some new faces on the committee.

If you have any subject that you would like discussed or wish to make a proposal then please contact Chris Adams (c.adams359@btinternet.com or 07800 735764).

Remember it is your club, so this is your opportunity to have a say in the club's activities and how it is run over the next 12 months.

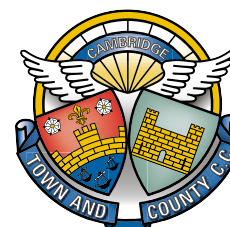
The AGM will be held at Christ's Church on Newmarket Road.



Cyclists' and Triathletes'

Training Camp

March 21st to 29th 2015



A training camp in Mallorca for members of Cambridge CC and Cambridge Triathlon Club.

After the success of our 2014 training camp, the Cambridge Cycling Club is pleased to announce that we're going to do it again in 2015. The camp, in association with the Cambridge Triathlon Club, is open to all members (except unaccompanied minors) and is particularly targeted at the people in the two clubs who train regularly together on the weekly rides in Cambridge. It will be organised and run by Tim Williams (www.perfectcondition.ltd.uk), who has many years experience of running training camps in Mallorca.

The camp will be based on a structured programme of group rides, and will include ad-hoc group and individual coaching sessions and discussions. The groups will be along the lines of those we already ride in.

We're trying to make the camp as affordable as possible. The two clubs have again agreed to subsidise the running of the camp so that we can include airport transfers. The cost will be £400 for a single room, £360 if you are happy to share a twin room and £340 if each if you book a twin room as a pair. You will have to book your own flights to Palma. Currently they are under £100 return with Easyjet and Ryanair (though bikes and luggage are extra). The prices will increase as the flights get booked up.

We'll be staying in the same hotel as last year: The Dunas Blancas, in El Arenal. It's close to the Airport and close to Palma. It's a great base for cycling, with access to the whole island, and for chilling out. For triathletes, or those who simply fancy a swim, there is a new swimming pool a five minute walk from the hotel and the sea is one minute away. The promenade is largely traffic free for running and there are some trails within easy running distance.

Accommodation will be 3-star half board. To reserve your place we require a £55 deposit. Please contact Tim (Tim@PerfectCondition.ltd.uk) for a booking form, or download one from the club website or from www.perfectcondition.ltd.uk/TrainingCamps/Mallorca2015.